

Starting the Game

To start a new game when the player clicks Play, add the following `elif` block to the end of `_check_events()` to monitor mouse events over the button:

*alien
_invasion.py*

```
def _check_events(self):
    """Respond to keypresses and mouse events."""
    for event in pygame.event.get():
        if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
            --snip--
❶ elif event.type == pygame.MOUSEBUTTONDOWN:
❷     mouse_pos = pygame.mouse.get_pos()
❸     self._check_play_button(mouse_pos)
```

Pygame detects a `MOUSEBUTTONDOWN` event when the player clicks anywhere on the screen ❶, but we want to restrict our game to respond to mouse clicks only on the Play button. To accomplish this, we use `pygame.mouse.get_pos()`, which returns a tuple containing the mouse cursor's *x*- and *y*-coordinates when the mouse button is clicked ❷. We send these values to the new method `_check_play_button()` ❸.

Here's `_check_play_button()`, which I chose to place after `_check_events()`:

*alien
_invasion.py*

```
def _check_play_button(self, mouse_pos):
    """Start a new game when the player clicks Play."""
❶ if self.play_button.rect.collidepoint(mouse_pos):
    self.game_active = True
```

We use the `rect` method `collidepoint()` to check whether the point of the mouse click overlaps the region defined by the Play button's `rect` ❶. If so, we set `game_active` to `True`, and the game begins!

At this point, you should be able to start and play a full game. When the game ends, the value of `game_active` should become `False` and the Play button should reappear.

Resetting the Game

The Play button code we just wrote works the first time the player clicks Play. But it doesn't work after the first game ends, because the conditions that caused the game to end haven't been reset.

To reset the game each time the player clicks Play, we need to reset the game statistics, clear out the old aliens and bullets, build a new fleet, and center the ship, as shown here:

*alien
_invasion.py*

```
def _check_play_button(self, mouse_pos):
    """Start a new game when the player clicks Play."""
    if self.play_button.rect.collidepoint(mouse_pos):
        # Reset the game statistics.
❶     self.stats.reset_stats()
        self.game_active = True
```